

Investigating patient preferences and experiences of waiting for heart surgery - King's College Hospital

SURVEY BACKGROUND AND INSTRUCTIONS

Survey Background Patients with heart conditions can wait a long time for surgery, which can cause significant distress. Therefore, clinicians, researchers and patients at King's Health Partners (KHP) are carrying out this study to better understand what it is like waiting for heart surgery, and to explore what is important to patients in how their heart surgery is managed. The results will be used to guide a future project to improve heart surgery services across KHP. This includes the following Trusts: Guy's and St Thomas' NHS Foundation Trust, which now incorporates Royal Brompton and Harefield Hospitals, and King's College Hospital NHS Foundation Trust. Potential improvements could include offering more choice to patients in terms of where, when and by whom they have their surgery.

As part of this study, we are inviting you to complete the following survey, which asks about you, your heart condition, your experiences of heart surgery services, and your views on how waiting for heart surgery could be improved. Taking part is voluntary and you can change your mind at any time. If you decide not to take part, or to withdraw after taking part, this will not affect your healthcare at all.

The study follows approved ethical and legal practices, and all information about you will be handled in confidence. Anonymous quotes taken from survey responses may be used in research reports and publications. However, your personal details will not be used, and you will not be identifiable in any of these materials.

The survey should take up to 20 minutes and will close on [DATE].

The survey is divided into four sections:

Part A: Background information

Part B: The impact of your heart condition on your life

Part C: Your experiences of heart surgery services

Part D: Your preferences for how waiting lists and services could be improved

Before starting the survey, please read the Participant Information Sheet (link below).

[Attachment: "PIS V1.1 20230630 IRAS ID 319498.docx"]

Survey Instructions The information you provide in this survey is confidential, and all questions are optional (just select the 'Prefer not to answer' option).

Return Code When you pause or complete the survey, you will be given a Return Code that is unique to you. It is important that you to keep a record of your Return Code. This will enable you to return to the survey and modify or remove your responses from the study, if desired.

There are two ways that your Return Code will be provided:

By clicking the 'Save & Return Later' button at the bottom of any of the survey pages - your Return Code will be provided along with a link to enable you to revisit the survey. By completing and submitting the survey - your Return Code will be provided at the bottom of the page. Returning to the survey To return to the survey, follow the weblink (https://redcap.link/waiting_for_heart_surgery_KCH) or QR code on your invitation text or letter. On the top right corner of the page, you will see a box labelled 'Returning?'. Click this and enter your Return Code.

You can also return to the survey by following the link provided through activating the 'Save & Return Later' function. This will prompt you to enter your Return Code in the same way.

Returning to the survey will allow you to review and modify your responses. You can save and return as many times as you wish during the period the survey is open (from date to date).

Withdrawing from the study If you submitted your responses but you would like to withdraw your information from the study, please return to the survey, navigate to question 3 'Do you consent to take part in the online survey about your experiences and preferences of heart surgery services?' and select 'no'. This will ensure that your survey responses are automatically deleted and will not be recorded as part of the study.

You can only withdraw your response while the survey is open. The survey will be open between Date to Date. Withdrawal after this time will not be possible because there will be no way to identify you and therefore remove your responses.

Download your survey responses When you end the survey, you will be presented with the option to download your survey responses, if desired.

Sources of Support If you would like some support around your heart condition or if completing the survey will bring up difficult feelings that you would like to talk through with someone, a list of organisations that may be able to help is provided upon submission of your responses.

Thank you prize draw To thank you for taking part, you can choose to be entered into a prize draw for one of 50 x £20 Love2shop vouchers. To enter the prize draw you will need to provide us with an email address. Your email address will not be linked to your survey responses. The weblink to enter the prize draw is at the end of the survey on the last page. You can access this page once you have submitted your survey responses. If you have won a Love2shop voucher, you will receive an email from waitingforheartsurgery@kcl.ac.uk after the survey closes on date.

- 1
- How did you find out about the survey?
- ☐ Through a text message on my mobile phone
- ☐ Through a letter to my address

CONSENT

- 2
- Did you read the Participant Information Sheet?
- ☐ Yes
☐ No

If no, please go back to the previous page where you can download and read the Participant Information Sheet

- 3
- Do you consent to take part in the online survey about your experiences and preferences of heart surgery services?
- ☐ Yes
☐ No

PART A - BACKGROUND INFORMATION

In Part A, we will be asking some general questions about you and your heart condition. These questions will help us identify whether specific groups of people are more likely to complete the survey and have different experiences of heart surgery services.

4

What is your age range?

☐ 18 - 30

☐ 31 - 40

☐ 41 - 50

☐ 51 - 60

☐ 61 - 70

☐ 71 - 80

☐ 81 and over

☐ Prefer not to answer

5

What is your gender identity?

☐ Woman

☐ Man

☐ Non-binary

☐ Other

☐ Prefer not to answer

5a

Other please specify

6

Which best describes your ethnic group?

☐ White Scottish/English/Welsh/Northern Irish/British

☐ White Irish

☐ White Gypsy or Irish Traveller

☐ Any other White background

☐ White and Black Caribbean

☐ White and Black African

☐ White and Asian

☐ Any other Mixed/Multiple ethnic background

☐ Asian/Asian British - Indian

☐ Asian/Asian British - Pakistani

☐ Asian/Asian British - Bangladeshi

☐ Asian/Asian British - Chinese

☐ Any other Asian background

☐ Black/Black British - African

☐ Black/Black British - Caribbean

☐ Any other Black/African/Caribbean background

☐ Arab

☐ Any other ethnic group

☐ Prefer not to answer

6a

Please specify

-
- 7 Which best describes your employment status? (Please tick all that apply)
- ☐ Full-time student
 - ☐ Part-time student
 - ☐ Full-time employment
 - ☐ Part-time employment
 - ☐ Part-time student, part-time employment
 - ☐ Homemaker
 - ☐ Self-employed
 - ☐ Unemployed, currently looking for work
 - ☐ Unemployed, not looking for work
 - ☐ Retired
 - ☐ Unable to work due to your heart condition
 - ☐ Unable to work due to another illness or disability (not your heart condition)
 - ☐ Other
 - ☐ Prefer not to answer
-
- 7a Please specify
-
- 8 What is your highest level of education?
- ☐ Primary school
 - ☐ Secondary school up to 16 years
 - ☐ Secondary or further education (A-levels, BTEC, Scottish Highers or equivalent)
 - ☐ Under-graduate degree (BA, BSc, NVQ) or equivalent
 - ☐ Post-graduate degree
 - ☐ Prefer not to answer
-
- 9 Which heart surgery services are you currently under the care of?
- ☐ St Thomas' Hospital
 - ☐ Royal Brompton Hospital
 - ☐ Harefield Hospital
 - ☐ King's College Hospital
 - ☐ Prefer not to answer
-
- 10 What heart condition are you having surgery for?
- ☐ Coronary artery disease
 - ☐ Aortic stenosis
 - ☐ Mitral regurgitation
 - ☐ Aortic aneurysm
 - ☐ Unsure
 - ☐ Other
 - ☐ Prefer not to answer
-
- 10a Please specify
-
- 11 Is your heart condition congenital? (Congenital means a condition that has been present since birth)
- ☐ Yes
 - ☐ No
 - ☐ Don't know
 - ☐ Prefer not to answer
-
- 11a When was your heart condition diagnosed? (Please enter an approximate date if the actual date is unknown)
-
- 12 Have you ever had heart surgery before? (Heart surgery is any type of surgery where the chest is cut open and surgery is performed on the muscles, valves, or arteries of the heart e.g. a coronary artery bypass graft (CABG) or an aortic valve replacement. Stent insertion is not considered heart surgery, but a cardiology procedure.)
- ☐ Yes
 - ☐ No
 - ☐ Unsure
 - ☐ Prefer not to answer

12a How many times have you had heart surgery?

13 Have you had a consultation with a heart surgeon to discuss your upcoming surgery?

- ☐ Yes
☐ No
☐ Unsure
☐ Prefer not to answer

14 Do you know when (i.e., the date) you were added to the heart surgery waiting list for your upcoming surgery?

- ☐ Yes
☐ No
☐ Unsure
☐ Prefer not to answer

14a Please specify the date you were added to the waiting list. (Please enter an approximate date if the actual date is unknown)

15 Have you been given a date for your heart surgery yet?

- ☐ Yes
☐ No
☐ Unsure
☐ Prefer not to answer

15a Please specify the date of your heart surgery. (Please enter an approximate date if the actual date unknown)

16 Are you currently using any digital tools (e.g. Ortus iHealth) provided by your hospital to monitor symptoms of your heart condition while waiting for your surgery?

- ☐ Yes
☐ No
☐ Unsure
☐ Prefer not to answer

PART B: THE IMPACT OF YOUR HEART CONDITION

In Part B, we will be asking about the impact that your heart condition has on your life.

17

Do you worry about your heart condition?

☐ Never

☐ Rarely

☐ Some of the time

☐ Most of the time

☐ All or almost all the time

☐ Prefer not to answer

17a

If you have any further thoughts about this (e.g. what do you worry about and how does this worry impact you), please provide a comment in the box

18

Does your heart condition interfere with your daily activities (e.g. shopping, bathing, dressing)?

☐ Never

☐ Rarely

☐ Some of the time

☐ Most of the time

☐ All or almost all of the time

☐ Prefer not to answer

18a

If you have any further thoughts about this (e.g. examples of how your heart condition interferes with certain daily activities), please provide a comment in the box

19

Does your heart condition interfere with your social activities (e.g. visiting friends and family, talking to other people)?

☐ Never

☐ Rarely

☐ Some of the time

☐ Most of the time

☐ All or almost all the time

☐ Prefer not to answer

19a

If you have any further thoughts about this (e.g. examples of how your heart condition interferes with certain social activities), please provide a comment in the box

20

Does your heart condition interfere with your studying or work within or outside the home?

☐ Never

☐ Rarely

☐ Some of the time

☐ Most of the time

☐ All or almost all the time

☐ Prefer not to answer

20a

If you have any further thoughts about this (e.g. examples of how your heart condition interferes with your studying or work), please provide a comment in the box

21

Does your heart condition interfere with your hobbies?

☐ Never

☐ Rarely

☐ Some of the time

☐ Most of the time

☐ All or almost all the time

☐ Prefer not to answer

21a If you have any further thoughts about this (e.g. examples of how your heart condition interferes with hobbies), please provide a comment in the box

22 Does your heart condition interfere with your sex life?

- ☐ Never
☐ Rarely
☐ Some of the time
☐ Most of the time
☐ All or almost all the time
☐ Prefer not to answer
-

22a If you have any further thoughts about this (e.g. examples of how your heart condition interferes with your sex life), please provide a comment in the box

23 Does your heart condition impact those around you (e.g. family or friends)?

- ☐ Never
☐ Rarely
☐ Some of the time
☐ Most of the time
☐ All or almost all of the time
☐ Prefer not to answer
-

23a If you have any further thoughts about this (e.g. examples of how your heart condition impacts those around you), please provide a comment in the box

24 Does your heart condition interfere with your life in any other way that we haven't already asked about?

- ☐ Yes
☐ No
☐ Prefer not to answer
-

24a Please specify in what other way(s) your heart condition interferes with your life

The following questions are about how you have been feeling recently.

Over the last two weeks, how often have you been bothered by the following problems?

		Not at all	Several days	More than half the days	Nearly every day	Prefer not to answer
25	Feeling nervous, anxious or on edge	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
26	Not being able to stop or control worrying	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
27	Feeling down, depressed or hopeless	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
28	Little interest or pleasure in doing things	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

PART C: YOUR EXPERIENCE OF HEART SURGERY SERVICES**In Part C, we will be asking about your experiences of heart surgery services.**

- 29 Would you be willing to share how being on the waiting list for heart surgery makes you feel? ☐ Yes
☐ No
☐ Prefer not to answer
-
- 29a Please specify how being on the waiting list makes you feel.

-
- 30 Were you told how long you might need to wait for your heart surgery? ☐ Yes
☐ No
☐ Unsure
☐ Prefer not to answer
-
- 31 Do you feel that the process of prioritising patients on the waiting list is clear and fair? ☐ Yes
☐ No
☐ Unsure
☐ Prefer not to answer
-
- 32 Do you feel you have received enough information from your clinical team about what to expect while you are on the waiting list? ☐ Yes
☐ No
☐ Unsure
☐ Prefer not to answer
-
- 33 Has your heart surgery ever been cancelled while being on the waiting list? ☐ Yes
☐ No
☐ Unsure
☐ Prefer not to answer
-
- 33a Who cancelled the heart surgery? ☐ The hospital
☐ Me
☐ Someone else
☐ Unsure
☐ Prefer not to answer
-
- 33b Please use the text box below if you would like to explain why your surgery was cancelled.

-
- 34 Do you understand what possible risks might be involved in your heart surgery? ☐ Yes
☐ No
☐ Unsure
☐ Prefer not to answer
-
- 35 Do you feel confident that you could contact the right person if you had a problem or your symptoms changed? ☐ Yes
☐ No
☐ Unsure
☐ Prefer not to answer
-
- 36 Do you feel your clinical team acknowledges how difficult it is for you to be on a waiting list for heart surgery? ☐ Yes
☐ No
☐ Unsure
☐ Prefer not to answer

37

Do you feel you have received enough guidance about where to access emotional support, if you need it, while waiting for heart surgery?

☐ Yes

☐ No

☐ Unsure

☐ Prefer not to answer

38

Would you like to share any further thoughts or comments about your experiences of heart surgery services, that haven't been fully covered in the preceding questions?

☐ Yes

☐ No

☐ Prefer not to answer

38a

Please share any further thoughts or comments about your experiences of heart surgery services.

PART D: YOUR PREFERENCES FOR HOW WAITING LISTS AND SERVICES COULD BE IMPROVED

In Part D, we will be asking about your thoughts and preferences on how heart surgery waiting lists and services could potentially be improved in future. The healthcare you receive will be the same whether you answer these questions or not. All questions and comment boxes are optional.

Some surgeons (all suitable trained and qualified) working at one of the NHS hospitals belonging to King's Health Partners (KHP) may have more availability than others at different times. KHP includes the following Trusts: Guy's and St Thomas' NHS Foundation Trust, which now incorporates Royal Brompton and Harefield hospitals, and King's College Hospital NHS Foundation Trust.

Having your heart operation performed by the first available surgeon from a wider team of surgeons from one of these hospitals, instead of a surgeon you might have already had a consultation with, could be one way to have your operation sooner. However, this might also mean not meeting your heart surgeon until the day of your surgery. Safety and clinical outcome would be the same in all cases.

- 39

Would you find it acceptable to have your heart surgery performed by the first available surgeon from a wider team of surgeons?

☐ Yes

☐ No

☐ Unsure

☐ Prefer not to answer
- 40

Is it important to you whether the surgeon who performs your heart surgery is a surgeon you already had a consultation with, instead of one from a wider team of surgeons? (A surgeon from a wider team might be available to do your surgery sooner, but you might only meet them on the day of your surgery.)

☐ Not at all important

☐ Slightly important

☐ Moderately important

☐ Very important

☐ Extremely important

☐ Prefer not to answer
- 40a

Would you prefer to have your heart surgery performed by a surgeon you already had a consultation with even if it meant that you had to wait longer?

☐ Yes

☐ No

☐ Unsure

☐ Prefer not to answer
- 40b

What is the longest additional time you would be happy to wait?

☐ up to 1-2 months

☐ up to 3-4 months

☐ up to 5-6 months

☐ as long as necessary

☐ Unsure

☐ Prefer not to answer

Having your heart operation performed by the first available surgeon from a wider team of surgeons, instead of a surgeon you already had a consultation with, might mean travelling further to have your operation. Your surgery would still be at one of the King's Health Partners' NHS hospitals. KHP includes the following Trusts: Guy's and St Thomas' NHS Foundation Trust, which now incorporates Royal Brompton and Harefield hospitals, and King's College Hospital NHS Foundation Trust.

- 41

Would you be willing and able to travel further to the hospital for your heart surgery, if it meant that you could have your heart surgery sooner?

☐ Yes, I'm willing and able to go to any specialist hospital no matter the distance

☐ No, I would prefer to go to my nearest specialist hospital

☐ Unsure

☐ Prefer not to answer
- 42

The previous questions asked about your preferences with regard to who performs your surgery, as well as where and when it happens. With this in mind, what is the most important factor for you from the list on the right-hand side, with regard to your heart surgery?

☐ Having a consultation with my surgeon prior to my surgery

☐ Having my surgery at the soonest possible opportunity

☐ Having my surgery at a location most convenient to me

☐ Prefer not to answer
- 43

Would you like to share any further thoughts or comments about your preferences with regard to who performs your heart surgery, or where and when it happens?

☐ Yes

☐ No

☐ Prefer not to answer
- 43a

Please share any further thoughts or comments about your preferences with regard to who performs your heart surgery, or where and when it happens.
- 44

Many people waiting for heart surgery feel anxious and worried. What factors could help to relieve the stress associated with waiting and/or help you feel more emotionally prepared for your surgery? (You can include things discussed in the previous questions if you would like.)